

# 1. IDEATION PHASE

## 1.1 Problem Identification

Organizations receive a large number of incidents through different channels such as email, phone calls, service portals, and internal communication. Managing these incidents manually can result in several problems, including:

- Improper or delayed incident recording
- Incorrect incident categorization and prioritization
- Assignment of incidents to the wrong support teams
- Delays in incident investigation and resolution
- Lack of proper escalation for unresolved incidents
- Difficulty in tracking related or child incidents
- Lack of integration between incidents and knowledge articles
- Difficulty in handling emergency changes required to resolve incidents
- Poor visibility of Service Level Agreement (SLA) status
- Repeated resolution of similar incidents because previous solutions are not properly documented

Therefore, there is a need for a **structured and automated Incident Lifecycle Management system** that manages an incident from its creation until its final resolution and closure.

## 1.2 Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is an **Incident Lifecycle Automation System using ServiceNow**.

The system provides an end-to-end process for handling incidents. It allows users and support teams to create incidents, classify them according to category and priority, assign them to appropriate support groups, track their progress, escalate unresolved incidents, create related child incidents, use existing knowledge articles, create emergency change requests when necessary, and finally resolve and close the incident.

The solution also uses ServiceNow features such as incident management, assignment groups, knowledge management, change management, related records, and SLA tracking to provide a centralized incident-management process.

## 1.3 Project Objective

The main objective of this project is to design and implement an automated incident lifecycle management process in ServiceNow that improves the efficiency, consistency, and traceability of incident handling.

The system should ensure that every incident follows a defined process from **creation** → **classification** → **assignment** → **investigation** → **escalation/change handling** → **resolution** → **closure**.

## 1.4 Business Objectives

The major business objectives are:

- Enable Service Desk agents to create and manage incidents efficiently.
- Improve incident classification using appropriate categories, subcategories, impact, urgency, and priority.
- Assign incidents to appropriate support groups.
- Reduce manual effort involved in incident management.
- Provide Level 2 escalation for incidents that require advanced technical support.
- Support the creation and tracking of child incidents.
- Integrate Knowledge Management with Incident Management.
- Allow emergency change requests to be associated with incidents when infrastructure or application changes are required.
- Track SLA performance throughout the incident lifecycle.
- Maintain complete information about incident activities and related records.
- Improve incident-resolution time.
- Maintain reusable solutions through knowledge articles.
- Improve visibility and accountability among support teams.

## 1.5 Scope of the Project

The project covers the complete lifecycle of an incident in ServiceNow.

The major functionalities included in the scope are:

1. Service/Service Offering creation
2. Incident record creation
3. Incident classification
4. Assignment and escalation
5. Knowledge integration
6. Emergency change-request creation
7. Child incident creation
8. Incident resolution
9. Knowledge creation
10. SLA and related-record validation

## 1.6 Expected Outcome

At the completion of the project, a functional ServiceNow-based incident management workflow will be available.

The solution will:

- Record incidents systematically.
- Categorize incidents correctly.
- Route incidents to appropriate support teams.
- Support escalation to higher-level teams.
- Connect incidents with relevant knowledge articles.
- Maintain relationships between parent and child incidents.
- Associate emergency changes with incidents.
- Track incident status throughout its lifecycle.
- Monitor SLA information.
- Document solutions for future reference.